

Lobo Baseballers Play 3 at UTEP

Journal Special

EL PASO — A third place finish in the Southern Division of the Western Athletic Conference baseball race will be at stake tonight and Saturday as the University of New Mexico takes on Texas-El Paso in a three game series.

The Lobos dropped to 26-21 on the season at 3-12 in the WAC last week, losing to Arizona State by scores of 6-1, 18-4 and 4-0. Meanwhile Texas-El Paso continued to have its problems in WAC play, losing three to Arizona to drop 0-15 in conference play and 15-26 overall. The Miners lost 15-12 in 11 innings, 6-4 and 8-2 to the Wildcats.

New Mexico needs one victory in the series to assure itself of a third place finish while the Miners need to sweep the series to gain a tie for third with the Lobos.

Lobo coach Bob Leigh will start Jim Weber (4-3, 2.28), Kent Seaman (7-5, 3.67) and Pat Beilsmith (7-5, 3.34) in the series. Mike Pettenuzzo continues to lead New Mexico in hitting with a .381 mark, but he is followed closely by Rob Ogle's .375 average. Pettenuzzo leads the team in runs batted in with 50.

UTEP coach Andy Cohen is uncertain of his starting rotation for the series, but will choose from five pitchers. Dan Modlinski (2-1, 2.08) who pitched a no-hitter to take a 3-0 win over Texas Tech earlier this season, has recovered from a pulled arm muscle and could get a starting assignment against the Lobos.

In addition, Cohen will look at Jeff Hogan (1-4, 5.66) Sam Cox (1-2, 7.88) *George Landreath* (3-4, 6.34) and *Mike Hilton* (0-1, 7.04) for the other starting positions.